> On another side may be a wine-merchant’s shop, and an establishment of singers and dancers, beautiful women adorned with various kinds of jewels, and fair-faced choristers, all ready to perform whatever may be desired of them. In short, the whole bazar was filled with wine and beauty, dancers, perfumes, jewels of all sorts, palaces and viands. In one street were a thousand bands of people drinking, and dancers, lovers and pleasure-seekers assembled; none quarreled or disputed with another, and this state of things was perpetual. Perhaps no place in the wide world could present a more wonderful spectacle to the eye of the traveller.

Throughout his stay, Asad Beg was deluged with gifts, ceremonies, and hospitality, in an attempt to delay his meeting with the Adil Shah. He was given 200,000 huns, which he refused. He was feted with ‘food, drinks, and fresh fruits, and good fodder for the animals’ and two noblemen were sent daily to ‘converse’ with Asad Beg and keep him entertained. Finally, there was an extravaganza of entertainment in which two firework castles were set alight, and ‘it was as if they were firing arms and cannon at each other, with an effect that was so frightening that the horses, camels, and elephants in Asad Beg’s camp entered into a panic’. But Asad Beg was made of sterner stuff than the mir and, unflustered, he insisted on a meeting with Ibrahim and the providing of a bride for Daniyal. After a great deal more resistance, the Bijapuri bride was obtained and she was married to Daniyal in the Sona Mahal of Ahmadnagar Fort. Asad Beg took back to the Mughal court a royal female elephant called Chanchal, who had been the mate of the sultan’s favourite elephant, Atash Khan. Chanchal, in true royal style, required two Akbari maun of wine a day, preferably Portuguese. Asad Beg also returned with a valuable Arab horse called Chini, in addition to a fortune in jewels and precious objects.

At Bijapur, Asad Beg may have been surprised to discover the presence of Farrukh Beg, erstwhile painter at the Mughal court. Around the year 1597, Farrukh Beg, for some unexplained reason, left the Mughal court for the Deccan where he joined the service of Ibrahim Adil Shah II. Mughal sources, not overly anxious to elaborate on this absence, never mention the departure of Farrukh Beg from the court. Perhaps he, too, was offered gifts he found himself unable to refuse in Bijapur or perhaps the painter found the atmosphere of hostility between the Padshah and Salim uncongenial but, whatever the motivation, Farrukh Beg’s sojourn in the Deccan left a